

IQly quiz flow — why it is built this way

Part 1 of 3 — AI Quiz Flow · [index.html](#) (control, opens offline) · live: [yosishe.github.io/iqly-flow](#) · [?debug=1](#) shows the events

Decision. A disclosed post-quiz gate: the landing says before question one that the test is free and a free email-only account at the end shows the IQ range and rank; the gate screen shows the true count, nothing blurred.

Metric. Account creations / page visits (in production, verified accounts per eligible new visitor); every screen is justified by the funnel term it moves.

Strongest alternative. Score-first (range and rank free, the account for the review) is Test 1, its rule written in advance; a break-even, not taste, put the gate in the control.

THE ONE DECISION: KEEP THE EXCHANGE, DROP THE DECEPTION

The category has trained "free iq test" searchers to expect a trap: 16 of the 19 live funnels in the sweep Claude Code ran and I reviewed withhold the number behind email, a trial or a subscription, and complaint corpora repeat "the test is free but the results are not". My first build showed the range free; a break-even changed my mind. The metric is accounts per visit, the brief ends the funnel "the moment they hand over an email", and the gate on the range is the screen with the largest lever on signup per finisher: at illustrative magnitudes (a 40% gate rate against 12% for "save my result") score-first must more than triple starts × completion to tie, which no evidence supports. So the control keeps the exchange and drops the deception: no payment ever, the boundary announced above the Start button, a true result before the ask, an email and nothing else.

FLOW, AND THE TERM EACH STEP TARGETS

Step	Term	Key choice
Landing	start	Ad promise word for word; "12 questions · ~5 min"; free/account block above the CTA, inside the first phone viewport
12 questions	completion	One per screen, auto-advance, Back and Skip, easy → hard, 4 areas × 3, no timer
Gate screen	signup given exposure; trust	Count line, one explanation, by-area counts one tap away; account card; CTA in the first viewport
Signup	signup; validity	Email only, consent unticked, prototype note; storage verified by read-back
Full result	value; return	Range, illustrative rank and curve, answer review, every attempt listed, retake, delete

DECISIONS THE EVIDENCE FORCED

A range, not a number. The brief says IQly "scores" IQ; I used an explicitly illustrative IQ range rather than a precise number because this unnormed prototype cannot support that precision: 12-item matrix short forms reach $\alpha \approx .65-.73$ (Bors & Stokes 1998; Condon & Revelle 2014), a standard error near 9 IQ points, and three items per area give α near .3 [INFERENCE for this bank], so no "Your IQ is 127" and no four-area "profile"; the rank is labelled an illustrative estimate. **No timer:** time pressure cuts matrix accuracy by about a third of a standard deviation (Gonthier 2023 [EVIDENCE]); "~5 min" is an estimate until measured. **The CTA is measured, not assumed:** landing 576 px and gate 638 px at 375×667, inside the first screen from 375 px up.

WHAT IS HONEST ABOUT THE PROTOTYPE

Account creation is simulated: the email is syntax-checked and kept in this browser; nothing is sent or verified, no server account exists, and the signup screen says so. Storage writes are verified by read-back; a blocked browser is told "kept for this tab only" before the account step. Every attempt is listed, "delete my account and data" works, events (32 types, the email never logged) stay local, and 32 offline end-to-end runs pass on macOS Chrome and Linux Chromium.

WHERE AI HELPED, AND WHERE IT DID NOT DECIDE

Claude Code ran the research, generated the items, the state machine, the variant build with its diffs, the test and fold harnesses, reviewer passes and a pre-submission audit; it argued both sides of the gate decision and drafted the break-even. I set the constraints, reopened the gate decision with no default, checked the arithmetic and adopted the flip, chose the three bets and their rules, and vetoed every claim the evidence would not carry (DECISION-LOG.md).

Labels: [EVIDENCE] sourced · [COMPETITOR OBSERVATION] causal impact unknown · [INFERENCE] · [HYPOTHESIS]. No conversion benchmarks; the rates above are illustrations.